Victoria Sterling

Principal Software Engineer

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SUMMARY

Principal engineer with 11 years of experience architecting large-scale distributed systems. Led teams of up to 12 engineers, delivered systems processing billions of requests per day, and consistently correct in technical disputes that mattered. I don't do unnecessary meetings, and I don't sugarcoat feedback. I get results, and my track record backs it up.

EXPERIENCE

Principal Software Engineer, MegaCorp Systems *2020 - 2026*

- Architected a rewrite of a flaky internal service after telling the team the old one was a liability, cutting downtime incidents by 92% (I was right).
- Led a team of 12 engineers delivering a distributed billing platform processing 4B+ events/day at 99.99% uptime.
- Reviewed 1,200+ pull requests, holding the team to a technical bar that reduced production incidents by 60%.
- Delivered six major feature releases on schedule, three of which I flagged as under-scoped during planning and was proven correct on.

Senior Software Engineer, TechGiant Ltd *2016 - 2020*

- Told my manager his roadmap had gaps in a candid team email; the roadmap was revised within a week based on my analysis.
- Designed a caching layer that reduced infrastructure spend by $800K annually.
- Mentored 5 engineers who were later promoted to senior roles.

EDUCATION

M.Sc. Computer Science, Stanford University, 2016 (top of cohort)
B.Sc. Computer Science, Stanford University, 2014

CERTIFICATIONS & TRAINING

AWS Certified Solutions Architect - Professional, 2021
Certified Kubernetes Administrator (CKA), 2022

SKILLS

Distributed Systems, Java, C++, Go, System Design, Team Leadership, Being Right (unfortunately, frequently)

HOBBIES & INTERESTS

Competitive debate (undefeated, for the record), solo hiking, correcting people's Wikipedia edits